

Dr. Tobias Griebe

ENGINEERING DIRECTOR · IT DEPARTMENT HEAD ·
PLATFORM ENGINEERING

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

PhD computer scientist (Dr. rer. nat., summa cum laude) and seasoned IT leader with over 15 years of progressive management responsibility in technology-driven organisations at varying stages of maturity. I combine deep engineering expertise in software architecture, cloud platforms, DevOps and API ecosystems with sustainable people leadership and strategic IT management. My strength lies in driving IT transformation not as an end in itself, but as a measurable lever for business growth, operational stability and innovation capacity. I lead IT organisations from team-building through target architecture to governance, communicating confidently at C-level and with cross-functional stakeholders.

CORE COMPETENCIES

IT STRATEGY & ARCHITECTURE

Cloud-first / API-first target architectures · Enterprise Architecture · IT roadmaps & OKRs · Microservices & platform strategy · Application landscape modernisation · Technical debt management

LEADERSHIP & ORGANISATION

Disciplinary leadership of 50+ people · Engineering Manager coaching · Career framework & performance management · Organisational design · Recruiting & retention · Agile governance & value streams

IT MANAGEMENT & GOVERNANCE

Budget & investment planning (€1–5M) · Portfolio & project prioritisation · Make-or-buy decisions · Vendor & contract management · GDPR-compliant infrastructure · Audit-readiness

TECHNOLOGY & OPERATIONS

AWS · Kubernetes / Docker · Red Hat OpenShift · Spring Boot / Kotlin / Java · TypeScript / React / Node.js · DevOps · CI/CD · Incident & change management

DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION

Agile transformation (Scrum, Kanban) · Cloud migration & modernisation · Mobile platforms (iOS, Android, Flutter) · B2B/B2E product engineering · Requirements engineering & solution design

COMMUNICATION & STAKEHOLDERS

C-level & executive reporting · Corporate governance & alignment · Client acquisition & delivery · Cross-functional team leadership · External partner management

LEADERSHIP COMPETENCIES AT EXECUTIVE LEVEL

- ▶ IT financial management: CapEx/OpEx control, cloud cost optimisation (FinOps)
- ▶ Digital product & platform strategy (cloud-native, API economy)
- ▶ Sourcing & vendor management: provider governance, SLA management
- ▶ Organisational development: career frameworks, succession planning
- ▶ Enterprise Architecture Management: target architecture, fit/gap, EAM frameworks
- ▶ IT compliance & risk management: GDPR, audit-readiness, Zero Trust principles
- ▶ Corporate contexts: governance in matrix-organised enterprise structures
- ▶ Change management: cultural & structural IT transformation at organisational level

WORK EXPERIENCE

since 12/2025

Head of Consulting — Cloudfactory GmbH

MANDATE: 50HERTZ TRANSMISSION GMBH / ELIA GROUP

Strategic consulting and leadership mandate with **50Hertz Transmission GmbH / Elia Group**, one of Europe's leading electricity transmission system operators. The mandate covers two parallel tracks:

Product Line Product Management Lead — Accountable for product strategy, roadmap management, and product specifications for a product line of four technical platform products within a sovereign cloud platform for a DAX-listed infrastructure company: *Internal Developer Portal* (self-service UI for cloud resource and access management in a multi-tenant operating model), *CI/CD & Supply Chain Security Platform* (SCM, CI/CD, and software supply chain security), *Sovereign Artefact Registry* (sovereign artefact management, shielding the cloud platform from external third-party dependency providers), and *Release Promotion Service* (secure governance of application package promotion between air-gapped execution environments). Member of the extended programme leadership; reporting line into the programme management board including the CIO level. Outcomes: published product line portfolio, four full product specifications, four launched platform products, established product management process within the product line.

Platform Engineering Lead — Design of the overarching platform strategy, delivery steering, and executive-level client communication. Focus areas: cloud-native developer platforms, platform engineering, DevOps organisational models, and scalable delivery structures for complex enterprise environments in regulated infrastructure sectors.

AI INTEGRATION & DEVELOPER VELOCITY

A core element of the platform strategy is the design of developer tooling ecosystems that sustainably accelerate internal development cycles. This includes the integration of AI-assisted development tooling, automation of test and deployment pipelines, and building self-service platform capabilities that free development teams from central infrastructure bottlenecks.

02/2023 – 11/2025

Engineering Director — sevDesk GmbH, Offenburg

RESPONSIBILITIES & RESULTS

As Engineering Director, Dr. Griebe is responsible for two of the three pillars of sevDesk's R&D organisation: Platform Engineering and Growth & Retention. As one of Germany's leading cloud accounting providers in the SME segment, sevDesk grows at high velocity; both areas are directly and strategically involved. He oversees roadmap, technical vision, and architecture strategy across both areas, managing headcount and hiring budget in close alignment with the executive team. A central outcome of his tenure is the initiation and management of a company-wide application modernisation programme, migrating the grown product landscape to a cloud-native, containerised target architecture (Kubernetes/Docker on AWS). The technical roadmap is aligned via the OKR framework and operationalised into measurable quarterly goals.

LEADERSHIP & ORGANISATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Dr. Griebe has disciplinary leadership of 6 Engineering Managers, making him indirectly responsible for over 40 software developers across product feature teams and cloud infrastructure teams. A central focus was the strategic formation of the Platform Engineering pillar as a standalone unit within the R&D organisation, including full ownership of the hiring process for a dedicated Engineering Director position. He established a company-wide career framework and performance management system that creates structured development pathways, transparent evaluation criteria, and a performance-oriented feedback culture.

AI INTEGRATION & DEVELOPER VELOCITY

Under Dr. Griebe's leadership, a strategic shift-and-lift programme of the entire development infrastructure from GitLab to GitHub was executed. The programme encompassed the full transformation of CI/CD pipelines and automation landscape under a rigorous DevSecOps approach: security scanning, dependency auditing, and compliance checks are now embedded as integral components of every delivery pipeline. The migration to GitHub Actions simultaneously

creates the technical foundation for targeted integration of AI-assisted development tools and automated code quality pipelines.

TECHNOLOGY, METHODS & GOVERNANCE

The product stack includes Spring Boot/Kotlin, PHP, and React; the platform infrastructure runs on Docker and Kubernetes in AWS. Dr. Griebe established architectural standards and API-first principles as well as Architecture Decision Records (ADRs) as a governance instrument. Delivery quality and velocity are measured using **DORA metrics** (Deployment Frequency, Lead Time, Change Failure Rate, MTTR) and used as a steering instrument in quarterly reviews. The compliance-aligned cloud infrastructure explicitly addresses GoBD requirements. Observability is ensured through Datadog, New Relic, and PagerDuty; on-call programmes and incident management processes are firmly established.

04/2021 – 01/2023

Head of Software Development and Platform Architecture — Würth Cloud Services GmbH, Bad Mergentheim

RESPONSIBILITIES & RESULTS

At Würth Cloud Services, Dr. Griebe was responsible for both the modernisation of existing legacy systems and the parallel build-out of new platform components — in an environment combining the IT governance of a near-DAX corporate group with the speed of change of a startup. The system landscape targeted small and medium-sized craftsmen businesses, integrating mobile and stationary applications in a scalable cloud environment. Definition of the target architecture, prioritisation of the modernisation portfolio by business value, and management of operations and further development were solely his responsibility, including headcount and investment budget management in close coordination with Würth IT and the corporate board.

LEADERSHIP & ORGANISATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Dr. Griebe built the engineering team from scratch, leading frontend and backend developers as well as mobile engineers across the full employee lifecycle: from recruiting and onboarding through qualification and career development to targeted retention measures. In the corporate-backed startup context, he established a leadership culture combining technical excellence with entrepreneurial thinking and personal accountability. Disciplinary and functional leadership spanned cross-functional teams and required communication both within Würth Group's corporate structures and with external development partners.

TECHNOLOGY, METHODS & GOVERNANCE

The platform architecture was based on Red Hat OpenShift in the Würth corporate data centre, complemented by Docker and Kubernetes for container orchestration; the product stack included PHP, TypeScript/JavaScript, Node.js, Java, Spring Boot, React, and Flutter. Architecture decisions were made and documented in alignment with Würth Group's IT governance and security standards. Operations, monitoring, and incident management were the team's responsibility; integration into Würth's IT infrastructure required structured change management processes and regular reporting at corporate level.

09/2019 – 03/2021

Lead Product Manager — Durstexpress GmbH, Berlin

RESPONSIBILITIES & RESULTS

Product management for an extensive IT application landscape in retail, warehouse, and logistics in a hyper-growth environment with significant scaling velocity. Dr. Griebe designed and led the implementation of a mobile B2B/B2E software solution for over 3,500 warehouse and logistics workers, and developed a scalable system architecture in a Microsoft-based cloud environment with Docker and Kubernetes. C-level stakeholder management, requirements engineering, and agile project management (Scrum, Kanban) bridged business and engineering.

LEADERSHIP & ORGANISATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Disciplinary and functional leadership of cross-functional software teams across the full employee lifecycle: recruiting, qualification, career development, and retention in a hyper-growth context under high scaling pressure. Dr. Griebe established the product management function as an independent organisational unit and created structured development pathways and evaluation frameworks for the growing PM organisation.

11/2017 – 08/2019

Head of Competence Center Digitalization / IT Consulting — adesso SE, Dortmund

RESPONSIBILITIES & RESULTS

As Head of the Digitalisation Competence Center, Dr. Griebe was responsible for the strategic build-up and autonomous management of a profitable consulting practice at one of Germany's leading IT service providers. He acquired and delivered IT transformation projects at enterprise clients with project volumes of €1–5M, spanning initial requirements analysis, fit/gap assessments, make-or-buy decisions, and delivery of complex cloud-native architectures. The practice was established as a standalone profit-centre unit with demonstrable growth in new client business, serving clients in finance and insurance sectors.

LEADERSHIP & ORGANISATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Dr. Griebe built an interdisciplinary consulting and development team of up to 20 people, taking disciplinary and functional leadership responsibility across the full employee lifecycle. He developed structured competency pathways, conducted regular performance and potential reviews, and established systematic knowledge transfer within the team. He entered the leadership role as team lead (06/2016) and assumed overall management of the Competence Center within eighteen months (11/2017).

TECHNOLOGY, METHODS & GOVERNANCE

Consulting projects covered cloud-native architectures with microservices, Java Spring Boot, Docker, and Kubernetes, as well as the design of mobile applications and the introduction of agile governance models (Scrum, Kanban) at enterprise clients. Requirements engineering, solution design, and architecture reviews on the client side were integral elements of the project roles. Project management and documentation used Jira, Confluence, and MS-TFS.

06/2016 – 11/2017

Team Lead Digitalisation Consulting — adesso SE, Dortmund

RESPONSIBILITIES & RESULTS

Functional ownership and team leadership in digitalisation consulting and mobile systems. Dr. Griebe led consulting projects at enterprise clients, managed requirements analysis, and designed scalable software architectures for backend systems and mobile applications. In this role, he laid the substantive and organisational foundation for the subsequent build-up of the Digitalisation Competence Center.

LEADERSHIP & ORGANISATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Disciplinary and functional leadership and mentoring of 10+ team members in consulting engagements. Dr. Griebe fostered team cohesion and managed systematic knowledge transfer within the team; the combination of technical expertise and leadership capability prepared the rapid progression to Competence Center management.

01/2014 – 04/2016

Team Lead Mobile Applications & Processes — paluno / University of Duisburg-Essen, Essen

RESPONSIBILITIES & RESULTS

Autonomous leadership of the Mobile Applications & Processes research group at the Chair for Software Engineering. Dr. Griebe advanced subject development in mobile application architectures, test automation, and context-aware systems, and managed industry-oriented development and consulting projects to generate external funding.

LEADERSHIP & ORGANISATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Functional leadership and mentoring of 6–7 research associates in project engagements as well as methodological coaching of doctoral candidates through the PhD process. Dr. Griebe established a collaborative research culture and managed knowledge transfer between academic and industrial project partners.

EDUCATION

04/2017

Doctorate Dr. rer. nat. / PhD — *summa cum laude*

“Method and Technology for Model-based Automation of Software Tests for Context-Aware Mobile Applications”

SKILLS

LEADERSHIP & PEOPLE DEVELOPMENT

Disciplinary and functional leadership of technical teams at all levels — from individual contributors to Engineering Managers. Building and steering teams across the full lifecycle: recruiting, onboarding, qualification, career development, and retention. Coaching and mentoring of managers and individual contributors. Performance and potential evaluation; goal-oriented use of people development instruments. Team health assessments; fostering psychological safety and team cohesion.

ENGINEERING MANAGEMENT & IT GOVERNANCE

Technical vision and roadmap ownership across multiple teams and products. IT governance: rollout of SAST tooling in CI/CD pipelines (GitLab, GitHub Actions), mandatory workload tagging, security policies. Observability: Datadog, New Relic, PagerDuty, Sentry. On-call and incident management programs. Architecture documentation with Arc42. DORA metrics as a steering instrument. Organizational design and career frameworks for engineering organizations.

AGILE METHODS & UX

Scrum, Kanban; agile transformation and coaching. Customer Safari, Customer Journey, User Story Mapping, Personas, Business Model Canvas, Touch Point Analysis, Interaction Room. BPMN, UML, EPK, Petri-Nets. Project management: Jira, Confluence.

CLOUD & INFRASTRUCTURE

Kubernetes, Docker; AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Red Hat OpenShift. Microservice architectures; event-driven architecture; CI/CD pipelines (GitLab, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, TeamCity). SAST tooling, SonarQube. Subversion, Git.

BACKEND DEVELOPMENT

Java/Kotlin, Spring Boot; PHP; MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB. REST, JSON, XML. JUnit, Robotium, Calabash, Cucumber. PlantUML, UML modelling. Eclipse, IntelliJ IDEA.

LANGUAGES

German (native), English (fluent)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Professional Scrum Product Owner PSPO I (scrum.org)
- Professional Agile Leadership I (scrum.org)
- ISTQB Certified Tester Foundation Level
- Certified Professional Leadership PROAKTIV Licence to Lead
- Interaction-Room-Coach — Foundation Level